

Installing Claude Code on Your Mac

Hi Shelly! This guide will walk you through installing Claude Code step by step. Don't worry if you've never used the command line before - I'll explain everything.

What You're Installing

Claude Code is an AI coding assistant that runs in your Terminal. It can help you write code, fix bugs, and build projects.

Step 1: Open Terminal

1. Press **Command + Space** on your keyboard (opens Spotlight)
2. Type **Terminal**
3. Press **Enter**

A window with a black or white background will open. This is where you'll type commands.

Step 2: Check if Node.js is Installed

Copy and paste this into Terminal, then press **Enter**:

```
node --version
```

If you see a number like **v18.0.0** or **higher** → Skip to Step 4

If you see “**command not found**” → Continue to Step 3

Step 3: Install Node.js

Option A: Download from Website (Easiest)

1. Go to: **<https://nodejs.org>**
2. Click the big green button that says “**LTS**” (recommended)
3. Open the downloaded file
4. Follow the installer prompts (just click Continue/Next)
5. When done, **close Terminal and reopen it** (important!)
6. Go back to Step 2 to verify it worked

Option B: Using Homebrew (if you have it)

```
brew install node
```

Step 4: Install Claude Code

Copy and paste this into Terminal, then press **Enter**:

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Wait for it to finish (might take a minute). You'll see some text scrolling by - that's normal.

Step 5: Sign In to Claude

Type this and press **Enter**:

```
claude
```

Your web browser will open automatically. Sign in with your Anthropic account (or create one if you don't have one).

Step 6: You're Done!

After signing in, you're ready to use Claude Code!

To start Claude Code anytime:

1. Open Terminal
2. Type `claude` and press Enter

To use it in a project folder:

1. Open Terminal
 2. Navigate to your project (see below)
 3. Type `claude` and press Enter
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How to Navigate to a Folder

If your project is on your Desktop in a folder called "my-project":

```
cd ~/Desktop/my-project
```

Then type `claude` to start.

Helpful Commands Inside Claude Code

What to Type	What It Does
<code>/help</code>	Shows all available commands
<code>/clear</code>	Clears the conversation
<code>Ctrl + C</code>	Stops Claude / Exits

Common Problems & Fixes

"Permission denied" error

Run this instead:

```
sudo npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

It will ask for your Mac password. Type it (you won't see the characters - that's normal) and press Enter.

"node: command not found"

Node.js isn't installed. Go back to Step 3.

Browser didn't open for sign-in

1. Type `claude logout` and press Enter
 2. Type `claude` again
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Need Help?

- Anthropic docs: <https://docs.anthropic.com/claude-code>
 - Report issues: <https://github.com/anthropics/claude-code/issues>
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You've got this, Shelly!